

Day 5 — Yajña — The Ecological Cycle

Module: Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: read bg 3.10–14; map yajña to natural-cycle reciprocity.

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *sthāvara-jaṅgama* (IAST: sthāvara-jaṅgama; lit. “immobile (plants, rocks) and mobile (animals) life”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **The Gītā passage.** Bhagavad Gītā 3.10–14. Read the key verses: > *annād bhavanti bhūtāni parjanyaś anna-sambhavaḥ* / > *yajñād bhavati parjanyaḥ yajñaḥ karma-samudbhavaḥ* // > “From food beings come, from rain food comes, from yajña rain comes, yajña comes from action.” (3.14)
2. **Decode the cycle.** Yajña → rain → food → beings → action (work) → yajña (giving back). A closed loop where each takes AND gives. This is the ecological cycle in Sanskrit terms.
3. **Modern parallel.** Carbon cycle: plants take CO₂ → animals eat plants → animals exhale CO₂ → plants take CO₂. Water cycle: evaporation → condensation → rain → soil → evaporation. The Gītā verse abstracts this into a yajña frame.
4. **Source check.** Multiple Upaniṣads also discuss the give-and-receive principle. Cite verifiable references in `sources.md`.
5. **Modern relevance.** Climate ethics. “*If we take from nature without giving back, the yajña is broken. What does ‘giving back’ look like in 2026?*” (Plant trees, reduce waste, restore water bodies, etc.)

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Sacred Grove (or Local Ecology) Mapping* (see [activities/](#)). Today's slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Yajña — The Ecological Cycle.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See `homework.md` for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 *pañcabhūta*).